

BUSINESS & SALES DEVELOPMENT MANAGER

Rigid Packaging and Consumer Products/Appliance Industries

SUMMARY – Rigid Packaging Industry

Incredibly determined sales professional with over 25+ years of sales experience, knowledge and project management with a concentration in the rigid packaging industry experience with Distributor Management and Distribution Sales. I'm a hybrid hunter and farmer in all of my previous positions. Well-rounded business experience, attention to detail, strategic decision making, team building, and negotiations, organization & time-management skills, can work under competing deadlines, customer service, collaborative, customer-focused, client-facing, analytical, big-picture thinker, fast learner, and the ability to speak different platforms between all levels of Management, Package Development, Package Engineering, Brand Development & Managers, Purchasing, Product Development, Operations, Quality and Marketing, Contract Manufacturers, making for a completely unique, highly-attractive and purposeful background. Specializing rigid containers (bottles, containers, tubes, closures (metal and plastic, including continuous thread, lug/twist, dispensing, CRC, etc.) liners, packaging components, etc. in glass, plastic (blow-molding, injection, extrusion, thermo-forming etc.) and metal in the following industries with extensive product knowledge consisting of:

- Hybrid Business and Sales Manager – Developing & executing business strategies/account plans
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- Researching new and innovative rigid packaging containers and components.
- Experience in Custom & Stock manufacturing, plastics & Injection molding.
- Implementing innovative applications to apply to customers' products.
- Targeting brand owners, contract packagers, distributors and OEMs
- Consultative and solution-oriented selling by recommending and selling custom, stock and alternative packaging to customers, giving them the most current and functional packaging available for their products, thus contributing to their product's success.
- Well versed in custom designed/molded, standard & stock items and in glass and plastic. Manufacturing and processing knowledge of various industries due to the diverse range of customers, but not limited to:
 - Food & Beverage
 - Personal Care & Beauty
 - Health (Consumer Healthcare, Cosmeceuticals, & Nutraceuticals), Sports & Fitness
 - Pet Nutrition & Agriculture
 - Household & Industrial

Business development and regional expansion region managing target accounts and increasing account base, introduction to company capabilities, and increasing sales volume in a previously untapped region. Extensive Product Development and Project Management Experience. Trade show management.

WORK EXPERIENCE:

Account Executive (Business Development/Expansion TX to SE U.S. including nationwide customer base) Rigid Packaging Distributor

O.BERK – Sept.16, 2024 – Dec. 3, 2024, Union, NJ

- Focus during employment: Initial training on company procedures and including their exclusive systems of CRM, inventory, sourcing, etc.
- Analysis, contact with previous customers and researching target business and f/u on call-in leads nationwide.
- Working with internal departments on availability, sourcing, pricing, etc.

Senior Account Executive (Business Development and Expansion)

TIM PLASTICS INC. – April 2023 – August,2024, North East, MD/Texas and surrounding states.

Tim Plastics, Inc. is a leading manufacturer of quality plastic bottles and jars - HDPE, PET, Polypro

Focusing on custom and stock packaging for the following target brand owners, contract packagers, and OEMs.

- Vitamin & Nutraceuticals
- Food & Spice
- Pharmaceutical – Liquids, Pills & Tablets
- Personal Care, Pet Care, etc.

Business Development for new and existing clients that are product developers with Co-Packers/Private Label Manufacturers, Formulators of products. Also, working with Regional and National Packaging Distributors to fulfil their clients' packaging needs.

- Contacting and working with existing and target costs to assist the customer in achieving successful packaging in their target marketplace, needs assessment based on client's new and existing product lines, sales cycle management with production, market launch assistance, etc.
- Consultative sales working directly with co-packers and their clients.
- Presenting advantages of purchasing from TIM PLASTICS as their supplier of plastic bottles for their requirements.
- Opening new business and opportunities for TIM PLASTICS to supply in a cost-effective environment and with a mid-size manufacturer.

Business and Sales Development/Owner

INNOVATIONS IN PACKAGING – August 2018 – April, 2023 Greater Austin/San Antonio, TX

Working within the realms of new product development for companies that want to develop products and/or extend their existing product lines in all industries

Concentrating in Health & Beauty, Nutraceutical, and the growing CBD industry.

- Consulting clients on packaging solutions, whether it be stock, custom, or innovative new packaging technology.
- Conferring with packaging manufacturers on custom applications to fit client needs.
- Connecting Product Developers with Co-Packers/Private Label Manufacturers, Formulators, Compliance/Regulatory Laws with expertise in required testing and procedures, Standard Operating Procedures, etc.
- Works with a direct approach with clients from ideas/concept to completion bringing the product to market.

Southeast/Southwest Regional Business Development & Sales Manager

EMPIRE/EMCO INC. - January 2005 – December 2017 • Buffalo, NY/San Antonio, TX

Concept to completion through custom, private/proprietary molds and stock containers, closures and dispensers in glass, plastic, and metal. Complete engineering capabilities and manufacturing for consumer and industrial products covering all markets from Food, Health & Beauty to Industrial. Custom, Private/Proprietary Molds, and Stock Rigid packaging containers and components for the Health & Beauty Industry (hair, skin, sun), Food, Household/General Merchandise, Pet Care, etc.

Regional Coverage for the following:

- Southeast Region: Texas, Oklahoma, Arkansas, Tennessee, Louisiana, Mississippi, N & S Carolina, Georgia, Florida.
- Southwest Region: Texas, Oklahoma, Arkansas, Louisiana, New Mexico, Arizona, Nevada, S. Utah.

Travel 50+%

- Increasing total number of actual accounts for the company. Sales growth from opening new region with zero accounts upwards of over \$8 mil plus. Total yrly \$13-14 mil.
- Boosting total of new and target accounts, through Major/Key Account Management and Development, identifying needs Assessment, Implementing High Impact Presentations, Sales Forecasting/Closing and Consultative Sales Techniques.
- Presenting the possibility of custom and private/proprietary design possibilities for new and existing product lines to accounts.
- Working with existing target costs to assist the customer in achieving successful products in their target marketplace, needs assessment based on client's new and existing product lines, sales cycle management with production, market launch assistance, etc.
- Project Manager from concept with client to completion, includes collaboration with design engineers, manufacturers/molders both bottle and closures, thermo-forming packaging if required for finished goods, complete pricing cost to final terms, testing, production scheduling, expediting and maintenance of the entire account.

Southeast Regional Sales and Business Development Manager (Florida to Texas)

AIRSPRAY INT'L INC. - November 2002 - December 2004 • Pompano Beach, FL/San Antonio, TX

Innovative developer and manufacturer of new dispensing components, of state-of-the-art dispensers for consumer products. Experience in Distribution Management with presentations and working with their projects. The product range of Airspray is expanding rapidly with many unique dispensing solutions, all working without gas propellants. Sold various companion packaging containers, for the HBA (hair, skin, sun), Household/General Merchandise, Pet Care, Food Industry, etc. Managed and increased account base, product awareness and sales volume in a previously untapped region. Travel 75%.

- Developed, grew, and transformed an almost non-existent generating an increase of 87% additional sales in 2003 over 2002.
- Sustained sales growth of 87% in 2004 over and in addition to the sales in 2003. Quadrupled total number of actual accounts.
- Energized existing accounts and created new accounts, including Major/Key Account Management and Development, Distributor Management, Identifying Needs Assessment, Implementing High Impact Presentations, Sales Forecasting/Closing and Consultative Sales Techniques.
- Sales presentations-new applications to customers, pricing, needs assessment, sales cycle management with production, market launch assistance, etc.

Mid-West Regional Sales Manager**BONAR PLASTICS INC. - November 2000 - December 2001 • Littleton, CO/San Antonio, TX**

National Rotational Molder for rigid plastic material handling and insulated food containers, insulated and agricultural tanks, IBC's, bulk liquid and powder handling containers, spill containment vessels, custom molding products. Experience Distribution Management and direct selling.

- Business and Sales Development - Rotational molded proprietary products which are sold to a variety of industries, such as, food manufacturing and processing, meat, poultry and seafood, agricultural and wine and pharmaceutical, etc. Defined the manufacturing capabilities of the company and the stock products to end-users and direct accounts in newly expanded start-up region. Supported the independent sales representatives and distributors with product knowledge, presentation and sales closing when needed.
- Managed independent regional sales representative firm, regional distributors and national distributors.
- Developed relationships with sales force and customers to increase awareness of Bonar's capabilities. Project Manager between sales representatives and manufacturing facilities.
- Managed quality issues and product development for custom and proprietary molded products with customers and design engineers.
- Expanded non-existent customer base through consultative sales presentations about information on product line and capabilities of proprietary product line.
- Created new business through research of industries in region and usage of proprietary product line from both small accounts and national/key accounts. Achieved yearly target sales figures in seventh month of twelve-month period.

Regional Sales Representative and Branch Manager**RYCO PACKAGING INC. - July 1996 - October 2000 • San Antonio, TX**

Mid-West and Western United States distributor for rigid packaging containers (glass, plastic and metal) and packaging components.

- Sold stock packaging, researched, and developed new and unique packaging for customers through consultative and solution selling. Developed and expanded new division sales territory with support from local distribution warehouse and manufacturers for Central & South Texas. Selling into but not limited to the following market segments - Food & Beverage (including Wine), Cosmetic, Pharmaceutical and Nutrition (Personal & Health Care), Household & Chemical, and Industrial.
- Developed expansion of customer base, and retained accounts through entire sales cycle management process, from initial consultation and needs assessment through product demonstration, price and service negotiations, and final sales closings.
- Expanded customer base by 300% by developing strategic plans to provide high quality products at the best possible price and delivering products to customers to meet 'just-in-time' inventory requirements.
- Increased gross sales from \$675,000 to \$2.1 million in three years, which resulted in revenue growth for this territory.
- Strategically handled quality issues on glass, closures, and plastic items based on product capabilities and manufacturing defects. Served as a liaison between the manufacturer and customer to provide the most efficient production, pricing, cost, and turnaround time on private molds.
- Effectively and consistently furnished product knowledge to customers by researching new and unique products, which further enhanced packaging needs.
- Enhanced product visibility in retail markets by creating and sustaining relationships with clients, which resulted in increased consumer sales.
- Managed local distribution center, employees, shipping and receiving, inventory control and scheduling.
- Created and coordinated customer projections to successfully sustain adequate inventory levels and turnaround time of 30-90 days.

Regional Sales Representative**SOUTHERN CORRUGATED BOX, INC. - March 1994 - July 1996 • San Antonio, TX**

Independent custom corrugated box manufacturer servicing Austin, Houston and San Antonio manufacturers and distributors in a wide variety of industries.

- Primary responsibility to develop new customer base and service the existing customers in San Antonio, after the acquisition of a manufacturing facility in San Antonio.
- Developed customer design for new products, including shipping cartons, displays and product packaging to meet shipping requirements and protect products.
- Effectively communicated with customers to provide innovative ideas and creative solutions to their packaging needs.
- Successfully negotiated with cutting and printing die vendors regarding pricing and delivery issues in order to meet customer and production deadlines.

Sales Representative

BERLIN PACKAGING, INC. - September 1990 - March 1994 • San Antonio, TX

Distributor of rigid packaging, including glass, plastic, and metal containers, and packaging components.

- Sold stock packaging, researched, sourced, and developed new and unique packaging to fit customer's needs.
- Researched and Sourced new and innovative rigid packaging containers and components. Studied and implemented new applications to apply to customer's products.
- Recommended and sold new and alternative packaging to customers giving them the most current packaging available for their products, thus contributing to their product success.
- Successfully developed two new accounts, which were subsidiaries of each other. They both obtained Top Ten Corporate Status of all company accounts within two years.
- Project Manager for the entire project from concept to completion. Sourced custom packaging and dispenser closure, artwork, testing and final approvals for production, expedited productions for customer to fill products per their requirements. I am not sure about the total book of business for these; however, the POs were more than 1 million pieces with releases, which was approximately a \$10-15 mil. yearly account.
- Purchased stock and production commodities from suppliers/manufacturers for local warehouse and direct shipments to customer.
- Accurately processed invoices from freight companies, vendors, and office expenses to ensure the correct and timely billing/paying of all accounts.

Sales Representative

TEXBERRY CONTAINER, INC. - January 1987 - September 1990 • San Antonio, TX

Regional distributor of rigid packaging (glass, plastic, metal) containers, closures and packaging components, also a manufacturer/decorator of plastic containers

- Sold stock packaging, researched, developed, and sourced new and unique packaging for customers.
- Researched new and innovative products for customers, giving them the most current packaging available for their products.
- Recommended and sold new and alternative packaging to customers giving them the most current packaging available for their products, thus contributing to their product success.
- Successfully developed account base and sales to be the first inside salesperson to reach over \$1 million in sales per year.

SUMMARY – Consumer Products/Appliance Industry

WORK EXPERIENCE:

Sales Representative – New Braunfels Territory (Greater Austin-San Antonio, Texas Corridor) ACOSTA/MOSAIC for WHIRLPOOL CORP – October 2019 – March, 2023

As an experienced Sales Representative, I have a strong passion for success, an abundance of energy, committed to delivering superior service and performance, working independently and excited to learn and grow as a member of the team. Additionally, product knowledge is needed explain the benefits, features and technology with confidence, be able to educate consumers and sales associates, make product recommendations, and with attention to detail for various merchandising tasks.

This position is a critical front line role responsible for managing the sales and volume growth in specific geographic markets. This role directs, supervises, and evaluates the sales efforts of Big Box Retailers in the assigned Region to achieve annual objectives. The Regional Sales Manager develops and executes sales plans and strategies with store managers and associates and ensures compliance with all required company policies and procedures.

Responsible for supporting a geographic territory of national accounts and key independent trade customers both in person as well as virtually, to build relationships and ensure sales targets are achieved, all while identifying and analyzing performance trends.

- Build and keep essential relationships with store management, trade partner accounts, and sales associates through group meetings, incentives, lunch & learns, and other strategic activities to help drive sales.
- Responsible for increasing retail presence and sales through keeping the physical presence of products on display, managing plan-o-gram product placement as well as floor resets.
- Support a working knowledge of all products to deliver presentations and training to educate retail partners on clients' key product differentiators, messages, promotions, etc.

- Ensure that client displays are clean and showroom-ready; order and install missing parts. Gather field intelligence and report on specific competitive tactics and direct questions from retail associates related to product issues, allocation, and inventory challenges to clients' field sales team.
- Responsible for thirty retail accounts with approx. 20mil in annual sales.

Miscellaneous skills:

- Experience in regional sales, territory sales, etc. working independently.
- Experience with home appliances, specific to either retail, direct, business and/or national retail.
- Show an energetic and enthusiastic attitude and tremendous interpersonal communication skills as well as training and assisting sales associates in closing sales.
- Communicate effectively during 1:1 meeting, group presentations, and demonstrations.
- Ability to coordinate and lead formal/informal training events on product features and benefits within store, market and virtually.
- Independent and motivated team player who is tech savvy!
- Proficient in with over 2-1/2 yrs experience in Google G Suite, Salesforce CRM, Tableau, Concur, Motus, Everlance, etc.

EDUCATION:

Southwest Texas State University – Marketing/Management

SKILLS:

Strong working knowledge of all MSFT Suite products that include Word, Excel, and PowerPoint, Google G Suite, Salesforce CRM, Zoom Info, Tableau, Concur, Motus, Everlance, etc.